



UNIVERSITY OF LEEDS

LASER User Agreement

Document Information

Reference	LASER User Agreement
Category	ISMS Documents
Title	User Agreement
Purpose	Agreement for LASER Users
Owner	LASER Information Governance Management Group
Compliance	ISO 27001

Version History

Version	Date	Update by	Change description	Approved By	Date
1.0	07/04/2016	Samantha Crossfield	Initial version		
2.0	20/10/2016	Samantha Crossfield	Baselined version	Barry Haynes	20/10/2016
2.1	18/10/2018	Charles Hindmarsh	Removal of old links and updated to reflect GDPR, Addition of return of assets, clear desk, unattended equipment and confidential disposal added, secure transfer of information added and removal of USB,	Andy Pellow (Chair of IGMG)	22/03/2019
2.2	02/04/2019	Charles Hindmarsh	Data Protection Act 2018 updated	Andy Pellow (Chair of IGMG)	05/04/2019
2.3	13/08/2019	Charles Hindmarsh	Updated 5.3	Andy Pellow (Chair of IGMG)	30/07/2019
2.4	26/06/20	Harvinder Notey	Updated for LASER Azure platform		
3.	01/04/21	Dominic Frankis	Updated following feedback from IGMG	IGMG	01/04/21
3.1	13/05/2022	Adam Keeley	Added link to LASERdocs Safe Room Regulations		
3.2	27/09/2022	Andrea Rylands	Update links, training method	IGMG	12.12.22
4.0	29/02/24	Andrea Rylands	Update links to new location	Not required	_____

Contents

1. Introduction..... 5

2. Purpose of this document..... 5

3. Legislative Requirements..... 6

4. UoL policies and procedures applicable to the use of LASER..... 6

5. UoL Information Security training required prior to the use of LASER . 7

6. Third party Data Sharing Agreements (DSA) applicable to the project.. 8

7. Documentation required prior to use of LASER 8

8. Authentication and Access Control..... 8

9. Using LASER resources 9

10. Data Usage and Outputs 9

11. Security management..... 10

12. Monitoring and Audit..... 11

13. Costs..... 12

14. Return of assets..... 12

15. Declaration 12

1. Introduction

The Leeds Analytics Secure Environment for Research (LASER) is a University of Leeds (UoL) service hosted in the Leeds Institute for Data Analytics (LIDA) on Microsoft Azure.

The LASER platform:

- Provides a secure environment for the handling, processing, analysis and storage of sensitive and confidential data.
- Segregates projects at network level, protects data from the rest of the University's computing facilities and from internet access
- Has been built to high security standards that comply with ISO27001 and The NHS Data Security and Protection Toolkit (DSPT).
- Is managed and maintained by UoL IT Services and operated and supported by LIDA's Data Analytics Team (DAT).

Data used in LASER is classified according to the Turing Classification model (Tier 0-4) [See ISMS Document A5 Organisational Controls](#) for more information. All projects that have data that is classified as either Tier 3, Tier 4 or requiring DSPT accreditation must use the LASER platform.

- For 'Tier 4' data, LIDA provides controlled-access rooms (safe rooms) or controlled project space where only authorised project members can access restricted data servers.
- For 'Tier 3' data, LIDA provides restricted-access office space and two factor controlled remote access for processing this data.

Projects with Tier 0-2 data that use the UoL's other platforms (e.g. M and N drives, One Drive, or High Performance Computing platform), can also use LASER. However, these projects will be subject to the more onerous data security requirements and controls that LASER requires for projects with Tier 3 or 4 data classifications.

2. Purpose of this document

This document defines the conditions that need to be followed when using the LASER platform. Researchers are required to sign this user agreement, which can be used for multiple projects, prior to use of LASER.

By signing this user agreement you warrant and agree that you will not use LASER in a manner that violates laws and regulations, any UoL and LASER policies and procedures and third party agreements e.g. Data Sharing Agreements (DSAs).

We may from time to time update these terms. When we do you will be notified that the terms have been updated. Your continued use of the Platform will constitute acceptance of the updated terms.

3. Legislative Requirements

- 3.1 I will abide by the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) and the [Data Protection Act 2018](#) wherever it applies, and follow the guidance notes for staff that are set in the [UoL Information Protection Policy](#)
- 3.2 I will adhere to legislations, acts and regulations, including those listed in [ISMS Document A5 Organisational Controls](#) as applicable. I accept that ignorance is not an adequate defence for unlawful behaviour
- 3.3 I will not create, store or transmit material that is unlawful, indecent, offensive, defamatory, threatening, deceptive, discriminatory defamatory or otherwise objectionable and LASER reserves the right to block and / or monitor access to such material.
- 3.4 I will present a valid drivers' licence, passport or other nationally recognised equivalent in order to be granted access to LASER safe rooms, and follow the requirements listed in [See ISMS Document A7 Physical controls](#) and the [Safe Room Regulations section of LASERdocs](#).

4. UoL policies and procedures applicable to the use of LASER

- 4.1 I have read and agree to abide by the following:
 - [UoL Information Protection Policy \(IT website \)](#)
 - [UoL IT Policies \(IT Website IT policy search\)](#)
 - [LASER ISMS Policies and Procedures](#)
- 4.2 I will comply with instructions from people with delegated authority (e.g. IT assurance, Information Governance, LIDA Data Analytics Team) in support of these policies and information security requirements
- 4.3 I will raise any concerns or breaches of these policies (by myself or others) in line with the ISMS [See ISMS A6 People controls](#)
- 4.4 If I access LASER systems while away from the University of Leeds campus or from mobile devices, I will abide by the UoL requirements for accessing

information remotely and the terms of any third party or Data Sharing Agreements regarding remote working and access to data.

- 4.5 I will review these policies prior to using LASER, periodically thereafter and when I am informed that they have been amended
- 4.6 I understand that my responsibilities for information security remain valid beyond my use of LASER
- 4.7 I will not put LASER systems at risk before, during or after my use of them when using data that is classified as 'Tier 3' or 'Tier 4' (as set in the ISMS A5 Organisational Controls)
- 4.8 I understand that any breach of this user agreement will be handled in accordance with existing UoL procedures
- This may include restriction or denial of access to LASER, or other actions as the University sees fit, for myself, my team or my organisation
 - Where criminal offences have taken place, information about infringement may be passed to appropriate law enforcement agencies
 - Where an organisations regulations have been breached, information about the infringement may be passed to them.

5. UoL Information Security training required prior to the use of LASER

- 5.1 I have successfully completed all necessary training (<https://leeds.learningpool.com/totara/dashboard/index.php>) as communicated by the Information Governance Manager and provided evidence of completion (which will be logged). I understand that access to LASER facilities will depend on this
- 5.2 I will undertake any further training as identified during the course of my project (e.g. by data providers), and ongoing access to LASER resources will depend on providing evidence of completion.
- 5.3 I will undertake annual Information Security Essentials refresher Training every year and Information Security Advanced Training every 3 years. I understand that my LASER account will be suspended if this training is not retaken when required.

6. Third party Data Sharing Agreements (DSA) applicable to the project

- 6.1 I will abide by terms and conditions stated within the Third party Data Sharing Agreement (DSA)
- 6.2 I will only use, share or publish identifiable data (that is not publicly available) with informed consent or an otherwise legal basis and with ethics, governance approval providing it is permitted by the Data Sharing Agreement.

7. Documentation required prior to use of LASER

- 7.1 Following the receipt of funding or approval for my project, I will provide the following documentation prior to the use of LASER:
- Any external requirements, including ethical, legal, funding, departmental or project requirements (by completion of the following documentation: project proposal, data management plan (DMP), ethics approval, project costing, risk assessment, completion of training and a signed user agreement).
 - Data sharing agreement capturing information about data sources or providers and their consent or stipulations for data access, handling, storage, sharing, output and destruction, signed by UoL (where I am a UoL employee).
- 7.2 I agree to the University of Leeds contacting my HR department and / or providing a CV upon request. Such information may, for example, be used in verification and to set up appropriate access.

8. Authentication and Access Control

- 8.2 I will abide by the asset management and access controls rules as set out in [A5 Organisational controls](#)
- 8.3 I will abide by the [UoL Password Usage and Management Policy](#) for any passwords onto LASER systems. This includes:
- Changing, upon first logon, any initial default passwords I am given
 - Setting unique and complex passwords, as defined in the policy

- Keeping my passwords known and used only by me
- Not storing my passwords in clear text in any file
- Not using any 'remember password' feature offered by applications

9. Using LASER resources

- 9.1 I will use LASER resources as agreed in my project documentation (see section 7), and in accordance with any consent or approval in place for that data or project
- 9.2 Any changes will only be made with the agreement of the LASER Data Analytics Team, LIDA Information Governance and any necessary data providers, ethics and governance bodies
- 9.3 I will not bring unauthorised files or equipment to or take unauthorised files or equipment from LASER systems. This includes taking snapshots, notes or otherwise copying information when this may be in breach of security or approved use
- 9.4 I accept that my usage may need to change as required by changes agreed to LASER resources and / or legal, security or governance requirements
- 9.5 I understand that general norms of acceptable behaviour apply as they do in the real-world and will not cause needless offence, concern or annoyance to others
- 9.6 I will not recklessly consume resources or interfere with other's valid use of LASER resources
- 9.7 I or my project team will notify the LASER Data Analytics Team should I no longer have a basis for using LASER resources

10. Data Usage and Outputs

- 10.1 I will adhere to any relevant data usage terms be they requirements from law, UoL, data providers, this agreement or ethics or governing bodies or the Data Sharing Agreement
- This includes terms regarding the usage, linkage, sharing and transferral of data or data subsets

- 10.2 I will not make any attempts at data re-identification or unapproved data linkage while using LASER (even to test a potential for re-identification)
- 10.3 I will immediately notify the LIDA Data Analytics Team should I:
 - Recognise a potential for re-identification
 - Make an identification from any de-identified data
- 10.4 I will acknowledge LIDA systems and services where they contribute to a publication or presentation
 - I will share details with LIDA for their reference

11. Security management

- 11.1 I and any guests that I bring to areas with LASER facilities will sign in and not be left unattended
- 11.2 I will not jeopardise the integrity of the LASER IT infrastructure and security measures. This includes doing any of the following without approval:
 - Damage, reconfigure or move equipment or the network, or make network connections
 - Load software or set up servers or services on the network
 - Introduce malware (deliberately or recklessly)
 - Interfering with network scanning procedures
- 11.3 I will keep secure any fob, identity hardware, key or other medium provided for the purpose of accessing LASER infrastructure. This includes:
 - Keeping these unmarked, about my person, and stored unobtrusively
 - Not sharing or giving these to others
 - Not altering these or making copies or enabling others to do so
- 11.4 I will maintain a desk environment that is clear of classified information.
- 11.5 If my PC is to be left unattended, I will lock my computer screen before leaving to prevent unauthorised access.
- 11.6 I will ensure LASER-classified papers are locked away when not in use, with keys held securely and/or securely disposed of, using a shredder, as soon as they are no longer required.

- 11.7 I will not provide access to areas with LASER facilities for unauthorised persons
- 11.8 I will scan any files I am providing using University-approved anti-virus software before submitting them for upload onto LASER systems
- 11.9 I will only use the secure portal (BISCOM) to transfer information in and out of the LASER
- 11.10 I will not submit files for upload onto LASER systems using a removable media or by email.
- 11.11 I will not follow links in emails or open email attachments where there is any suspicion regarding the content or sender
- 11.12 In the event of information loss, theft or damage or the identification of a security weakness, I will inform the LASER Data Analytics Team as soon as I become aware of it.

12. Monitoring and Audit

- 12.1 I understand that actions performed on LASER facilities are audited and subject to internal and external review. This may, for example, support: the planning and operation of facilities, the detection of regulation infringement and investigations into conduct.
- 12.2 I accept that in accordance with the [Telecommunications \(Lawful Business Practice \[LBP\]\) \(Interception of Communications\) Regulations 2000 \(Statutory Instrument 2000 No.2699\)](#) the University reserves the rights to monitor users' activities to:
 - Record evidence of official transactions;
 - Ensure compliance with regulatory or self-regulatory guidelines (including this Policy);
 - Maintain effective operations of systems (e.g. preventing viruses);
 - Prevent or detecting criminal activity;
 - Prevent the unauthorised use of computer and telephone systems – i.e. ensuring that the users do not breach University policies.
- 12.3 I will comply with any reasonable requests from the University of Leeds for information about my use of LASER systems within my project/s, to ensure

compliance with this agreement

- 12.4 I accept the use of CCTV for security purposes across the sites where LASER facilities are situated
- 12.5 I agree to the UoL processing my personal data as set out in the [University of Leeds Information Protection Policy](#)

13. Costs

- 13.1 The financial plan for my projects covers costs for the provision of LASER data services as agreed with the LASER Data Analytics Team
- 13.2 I accept that it is my responsibility to ensure that any LASER costs incurred by my project are managed in accordance with the financial plan and available budget
- 13.3 I accept that the University of Leeds may terminate or restrict my use of LASER, or remove my data from the LASER platform, if payments for its use become overdue or if I do not remove my data from the LASER platform at the end of my project and costs continue to be incurred
- 13.4 I accept that costs are handled in accordance with the University of Leeds financial procedures and will adhere to these

14. Return of assets

- 14.1 I will ensure that all equipment (tokens and key fobs), software, manuals and any other University assets are returned at the point of termination of the project or contract

15. Declaration

I understand and acknowledge the conditions herein (The LASER User Agreement) under which I may use the resources of LASER

Name

Position

Organisation

Address

Signed

Date